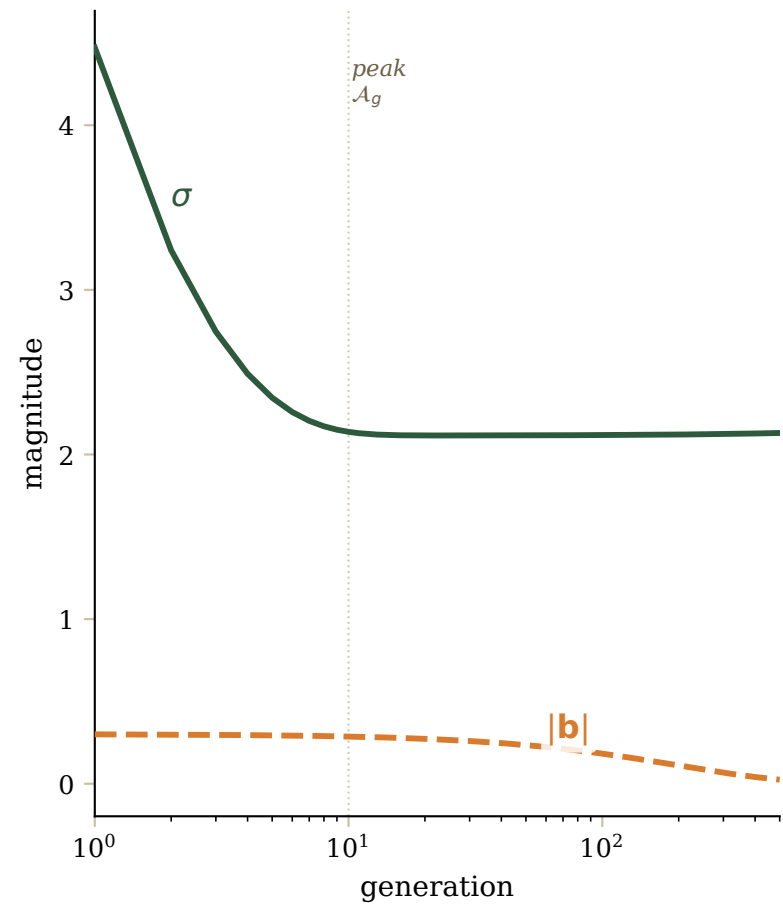
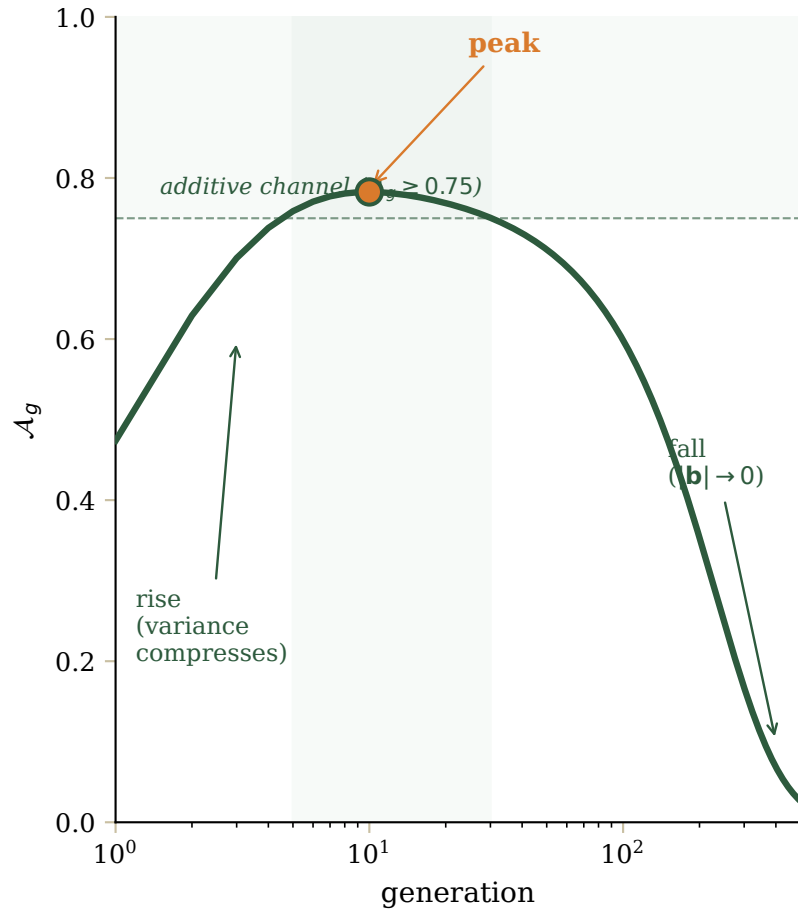


A. Variance compresses fast; gradient decays slow



B. $\mathcal{A}_g$ rises, plateaus in the channel, then falls



C. Phase portrait: trajectory through the $\mathcal{A}_g$ landscape

